

Learn the reason behind move order

Opening Decisions

THE IDEA

Two setups that look similar may differ because one move permits a tactic before the other piece is developed. Move order determines which options each side retains. Study the opponent's best response between your intended moves.

WORKED EXAMPLE

In an open game, castling before grabbing a central pawn may remove a pin against your king. Capturing first can leave the same piece tactically vulnerable. The final setup is irrelevant if the intermediate position loses material.

TRY IT BEFORE READING ON

How can you test whether two opening moves commute?

ANSWER AND REASONING

Play them in both orders and examine the opponent's checks, captures, and central breaks after the first move. If the available reply changes, the order has strategic or tactical meaning.

TAKE THIS INTO YOUR NEXT GAME

Evaluate the position between your planned moves.